Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: Nov 27, 2024 - 6:30 to 8:00

Google Meet: https://meet.google.com/uhn-thkf-bui

> *"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.*
> *They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.*
> *Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."*
>
> Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

A school council is an advisory body that functions within the parameters of Ministry of Education and Board policy. School councils provide an opportunity and the means to advise the principal and the Board on any matter pertaining to improvement of pupil achievement and enhancing the accountability of the education system to parents/guardians. The ultimate responsibility for the administration and management of the day-to-day operation of the school rests with the principal.

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome** - **Attendance**: Alison J, Tara G, Jason S, Shaun M, Nadine R, Elise G, Jess R, Amy L, Darpana S, Kate V, Heather T, Leah M, Carmen N - **Online Attendance**: Ling T, Jenna N - **Regrets**: Michelle T, Sandra B, A. Schofield, A. Buchan, E. Ambachstheer, T. Kauppila, H. Palffy, L. Paetkau, K. Yinger, K. Medencevic, A. Fraser, A. McGauley Meeting - Google Slides	1 mins	Co-Chair
2	**Territorial Acknowledgement & Equity Connection**	2 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
3	**Council Housekeeping** - Secretary nomination & voting, what this role entails- meeting minutes - Sandra - accepted nomination and voted in as Secretary - WRAPSC rep nomination & voting - Jenna - has been voted in as WRAPSC rep - Chair, Secretary recorded for the Pizza Subcommittee - Nominated individual will provide updates at council meetings - Heather Train will gather information from the members that will be emailed out tonight. - Chair, Secretary recorded for the Activity Fair Subcommittee - Nominated individual will provide updates at council meetings	5 mins	Co-Chair (L.Tam)

	- Carmen Chapman will gather information from the members that will be emailed out tonight - Approval of October School Council Minutes Will be sent for review and approval, draft has been completed - No new requested agenda items using the Google form Fill out form for next meeting if there are new items to be discussed for January's meeting - see link below.		
4	**News**		
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association - **Update** www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com - For more information, please email programs@silverheightsneighbourhood.com - Fall programs coming to a wrap this week and next - Winter after school programs start end of January, schedule coming out in 2 weeks - Pancake breakfast for youth ages 6-14 happening on Dec 7 (Saturday morning, pre registration and drop in as well, pancakes, arts and crafts) - Programs on Sat Dec 14 and 21, 6-12 ages if you want to drop kids and do holiday shopping - Girls leadership program starting again mid January ages 10-14, plan community project, learn about healthy friendships, planned a pet supply drive that is currently running now, can drop at St Gabriel's, wish list is on social media - Visit website if you would like more information	5 mins	SNA Representative (Jess R.)
	WRAPC/PIC - No Update in September https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/ - Meeting date: November 5, 2024 - WRAPSC Minutes - Reminder: Provide minutes to Executive Council 1 week prior to monthly Council meetings - Discussion surrounding letter to trustees for violence at school to give caregivers information about fights at school, maybe not applicable to all schools but only certain ones within the school board	5 mins	WRAPSC Rep (J. Northover)
	Teacher Update Here are some school updates: **Kindergarten:** Last Friday the Kindergarten classes did a special dress up day to represent their favourite celebration or event. Families also sent in photos of their children celebrating with their family. As the pictures are shown on the projector students have shared what their favourite celebration is and details on how they celebrate it. Monkey Movers- On Wednesday (tomorrow) we will have Monkey Movers come to the school as an on site experience for the Kindergarten Students.	10 mins	Teacher Rep (A. Schofield-regrets; T. Goudy)

Kindergarten Special Day- Move and Groove Glow Stick Party in the Gym (Tuesday, December 17th)

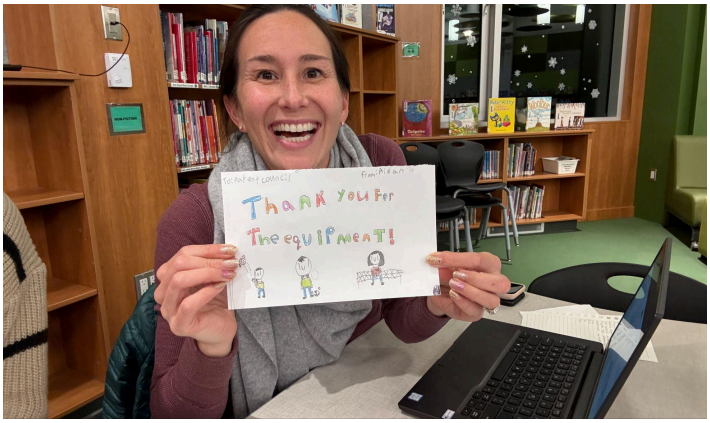
Grade 1 and 2 - teachers are being supported by our Early Reading Resource Teacher, as she is supporting in classes and running small groups for students. She is supporting teachers with effective strategies as our school continues to implement the phonics based program UFLI.

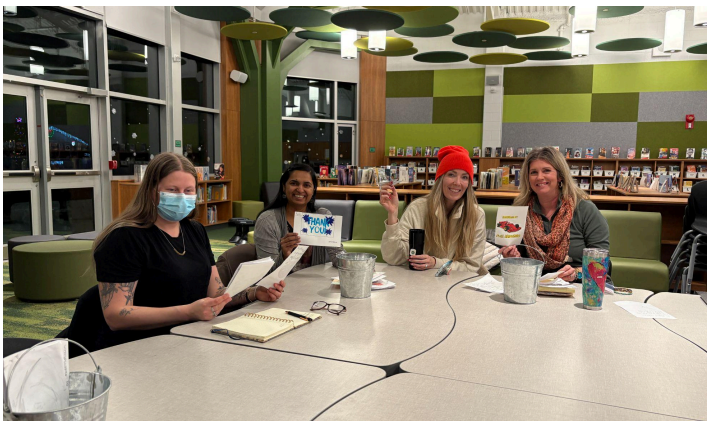
Mrs. Smale and Mrs. Schofield have gotten Strong Start up and running this week. Strong Start is a volunteer based literacy program. We have 2 parent volunteers who have committed to working with 2 students two times a week. Students will be lead through a variety of literacy based games and activities to support them with their literacy skills. If anyone else is interested in becoming a Strong Start Volunteer we will be running another round later in the new year. Please reach out to Andrea or Judy.

Phys Ed Department:
A big 'Thank you' to the parent council for the purchase of the new gym equipment. Grades 4, 5, 6, 7 have created some thank you notes.









Volleyball has been continuing this month students are having a lot of fun. Enjoying building team spirit.

School Wide:
November Spirit Day- Since the Umbrella Project Theme is Mindfulness, on Friday we are doing a "Drop Everything and Draw Day". Every Silverheights student will pause to do some mindful drawing at period 9 on Friday.

Sarah Cusinato and the Hawks Spirit Council is hosting a donation drive to support the "Starling's Comfy Cozy Holiday Drive".
Starling, formerly known as Lutherwood, is committed to strengthening kids' lives through their mental health and housing services. Each year they support hundreds of children ages 6 and up who often arrive with just the

	clothes on their backs. This holiday season can be so difficult for so many and we would like to do our part to help. Beginning Monday, December 2nd to Friday December 13th, we will be collecting donations of some much needed items for kids aged 6 to 18. December Spirit Day- PJ/ Comfortable Clothing Day December 20th		
5	**Principal's Report** - Literacy / Science of reading - sharing how it is progressing - kindie and primary kids were given a diagnostic - acadience - screened for early reading skills including phonics and phonemic awareness - our educators meet with acadience expert -this person (Mandy) is in our school full time right now. - Mandy supports teachers in interventions after the acadience screening - the screener results are indicators of kids who don't meet a benchmark and might need support - we also use professional judgement and acadience screener - may not do well on diagnostic - Mandy met with Jason to discuss strategies that make sense movin forward based on the results of the scrfeener. Here is the plan for support: - using a tiered system - tier 1 - whole class teacher strategy - tier 2 - small group - facilitated by the teacher or acadience expert, sert - support intervention - tier 3 intervention - withdrawal of the student - out of the classroom - focus on specific skill - goal is to shrink the literacy gap - There is a correlation between level of education over covid and where they are at in a literacy - Hope/Challenge - Ministry mandated communication of Acadience data with caregivers in the first report card - students could be in red zone in September - those results will be shared in January on the term 1 report card and may not reflect the growth that they have experienced between Sept and January	10 mins	Principal (J. Stere)

	- communication will be shared that there will be the disconnect - this will either come from the board or from admin out to the parents of the students who will have this screening result on the term 1 report card - if a child is struggling, there should be communication shared with caregivers in a timely fashion from the educator - staff is looking at UDL (Universal design for learning) - have a look at this website - https://udlguidelines.cast.org/ - what might be good or necessary for some benefits all - use good pedagogy and strategy overall in the classroom (needed for some, and really good for all) - Staff engaging in case studies including neurodiverse students from an asset based lens of what they can do and ways that we can put UDL strategies in place to support specific students but are good strategies overfall for all students - We had our board psychologist, SLP, and our board Spec Ed pro working with our educators to discuss UDL strategies that could be used based on case studies		
6	**New Agenda Items** - PRO/PIC Grant - Next Steps? - ideas shared - book club - tshirts (Words Matter) - guest speaker combining money - next steps - Does council want to do something with the money and put an application in? - present proposal to chairs - they send the email out to the larger council for voting - IDEA- Book club: Rising Strong- Brene Brown Provide snacks to encourage caregivers to join and attend without an equity barrier - possible ted talk use to support the book reading	5 mins	Vice Principal (T. Goudy)
7	**Financial Report** - Income & Expenses (live updates by VP) - Proposal of Budget for the year - Click Here for Treasurer Report - Nov 27 - Review: Requests for School Council Funds o Proposal for left-handed instruments ($1000) passed - approved	10 min	Treasurer (S. McCracken)

- Spoons to hand out from the office for students - $56.60- approved with caveat that these are used mindfully and ideally phased out
- Tuff Trays - Kindergarten proposal $700 Approved, please purchase with Black Friday sale

- Vote: Approval of each request for school council funds:
  - Left-handed Instrument - approved
  - Spoons - approved
  - Tuff Trays - approved

8	**Subcommittees** - Review: 2024/2025 members of subcommittees - nominations chair / secretary going forward **Best Practices for Subcommittee Meetings: (from WRDSB Handbook)** - Provide dates of meetings - Elect own secretary to take minutes - Provide minutes to Executive Council 1 week prior to monthly Council meetings - Documentation to be saved on Council Drive (not on personal devices) - Communications on behalf of Council to caregivers/community members shall be endorsed by School Admin/Executive Council prior to distribution - Solicitation for meeting dates & minutes from all of the subcommittees - **1) Fundraising Subcommittee:** - return to vote from last meeting - vote - yes - 0 votes - No further fundraising subcommittee at this time - **2) Pizza Subcommittee:** - Update: - Members from google form shared with Heather Train, Carman Chapman - Next Steps outside of the meeting (if approved): - Tara sends out email to all members - Heather Train will support the pizza subcommittee by organizing the Chair, the secretary and the volunteer organizer and will share this information with the co-chairs to share out with the larger school council group - Have a subcommittee meeting to establish volunteer scheduling workflow, if needed - Before January - Bring actionable ideas to be approved by council (if needed) - Support Pizza Days at Silverheights (ongoing) - **3) Activity Fair Subcommittee:**	15 mins	Chair (A. Jones)

	○ Update: ▪ Activity fair gmail to be managed by subcommittee, this is approved by council and administration ▪ Communication can continue to be sent out from the activity fair gmail account ▪ Messaging that goes out needs to be approved in a general sense by the larger council ○ Next Steps outside of the meeting (if approved): ▪ Members from google form shared with Carmen Chapman ▪ Tara will send out email to all activity fair subcommittee members ▪ Carmen Chapman will support the activity fair subcommittee by organizing the Chair and the secretary and will share this information with the co-chairs to share out with the larger school council group ▪ Establish objective for this event for Council approval (November) (from Oct) ▪ Establish potential dates for the Fall/Spring Activity Fair for School Admin approval (November) ▪ Before January - Prepare actionable ideas to be approved by council (if needed) ▪ Discussion needs to be had with Donna on number of people going through the gym with the potential for bad weather ▪ general guidelines for when/how we send out messages from the gmail for the activity fair ▪ Date needs to be finalized - objective needs to be clear - timing based on camps sign up ▪ before holidays, meet, communication sorted, shared with admin, can get started if needed		
9	**Questions & Answer Period**	5 mins	Council Members
10	**Next Meeting Date:** Wed Jan 22, 2024 - 6:30 - Library		In-person & online meet
11	**Agenda Items for Next Meeting** - Use Google Form to submit agenda items for next School Council meeting - https://forms.gle/ByrDqarD6Hythba66 - **Deadline for agenda topic submissions:** Tues, Jan 14, 2025 The mission of School Council is to work to ensure the highest academic achievement and personal development of all of our Silverheights students.	1 min	Chair (A. Jones)

	How to consider Go/No Go on agenda items? This will help Council achieve our mission: ● Endorsement by School Admin ● Teacher representation ● Student engagement & leadership ● Opportunities for involvement of community members
12	Adjournment

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools
(https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils
(https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)
General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

Treasurer's Report – November 2024

Prepared By: Shaun McCracken
Meeting Date: November 27, 2024

Current Approved Budget Status:

The following outlines our current planned/estimated revenue, planned expenditures

Silverheights Public School - Parent Council Financial Report Oct 23, 2024				
	Debit	**Credit**	**Total**	**Notes**
Income 2024				
Pizza Sales- School day*		$ 54,500.00		*95% of Projected Forecast for Revenue
Domino's fund code*		$ 500.00		*Estimate based on 2023/24 School Year
Misc. Income (WEFI, Brantview, Etc.)		$ 125.00		*Estimate based on 2023/24 School Year
Total Income:			***$ 55,125.00***	
Approved Expenditures				
Domino's Pizza	-$ 31,101.00			*Estimated Cost for Pizza Days
Phys Ed Proposal	-$ 4,500.00			Approved Sept 2024
Field Trip Transportation	-$ 4,500.00			Approved Oct 2024
Grade 8 Celebration	-$ 5,000.00			Approved Oct 2024
Breaking Barrier/Equity Fund	-$ 1,000.00			Approved Oct 2024
Folding Table(s)	-$ 500.00			Approved Oct 2024
8 x Dash Coding Robots	$ 2,334.55			Approved Oct 2024
Soundtrap for Education	-$ 1,500.00			Approved Oct 2024
Total Approved Expenditures:			-$ 45,766.45	
Proposed Expenditures				
Total Proposal Expenditures:			$ -	
Total Projected Available Funds:			**$ 9,358.55**	*Projected estimate*

Point to Note

- The budgeted revenue for Pizza Sales is an estimate. This is based on previous years' income. We are currently projecting 2 less days of Pizza Sales compared to last year due to how the calendar works this year and when we started sales. Initial tracking for Pizza Days shows sales similar to last year's numbers, with marginal increases year over year. If we stay on track with current sales, we should see us easily reach the projected revenue
- All expenditures outlined above in red have been approved and are in the process of being spent or have already been spent.

Current Cash Flow Status:

The following cash flow chart outlines the money that has been spent and projected revenue to date from our account. Big thank you to Mrs. Goudy and the office team who are keeping this updated for us, as they are spending the funds we have approved.

School Council 2024/2025

2024/2025	SEPT	OCT	NOV	Total
INCOME				
Pizza Sales	$ -	$3,112.00	$4,936.00	$8,048.00
Other Fundraising	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
TOTAL INCOME	**$ -**	**$3,112.00**	**$4,936.00**	$8,048.00
EXPENSES				
Pizza Cost	$ -	$1,890.00	$2,940.00	$4,830.00
School Day Fees	$ -	$381.81	$ -	$381.81
Approved Purchases & Amount Approved	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
Sept 26 - Phys Ed Purchase $5700	$4,500.00	$ -	$ -	$4,500.00
Folding Table $500	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
Nov - 8 Dash Coding Robots $2200	$ -	$ -	$2,334.55	$2,334.55
Soundtrap for Education $1500	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
Equity Fund (BBF) $1000	$ -	$249.97	$ -	$249.97
Field trip $4500	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
Grade 8 Field trip celebration - $5000	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
TOTAL EXPENSES	**$4,500.00**	**$2,521.78**	**$5,274.55**	$12,296.33
NET CASH FLOW	**-$4,500.00**	**$590.22**	**-$338.55**	**-$4,248.33**

Required Discussion Items/Approvals

At the time of this report being developed there were no financial requests that were outlined. However, that does not mean that funding requests will not be brought forward during the meeting on November 27, 2024.

Future Actions

For our December/January 2024, my goal is to continue supporting the Council & School Administration by working together to identify and document to council, the needs of educators and students for funding support. As is our goal as a Council, this will allow the impact of Council funds to be felt more swiftly, ensuring that students gain access to the necessary resources faster than in previous years. This is also so money allocated is spent in year, as it is meant to and required to be.

WRAPSC Report

What is WRAPSC?

- purpose: further support of student achievement through parent engagement
- WRAPSC works with PIC & supports them
- a single voice for each school council; a place to share ideas and learn from other school councils by group discussions; a way to understand how school council works; a place for the chair and WRAPSC rep to ask questions and get advice; a place to voice member's ideas, concerns and hopes to the board

Idea:

- Chair's Idea on how to promote school council and use the Ministry Grant on the principal's budget line: Make t-shirts for school council that say "Ask me how to join?" They also handed out candy. Laurentian school council.

Facilities and Procurement Update: Facilities' speakers: Lauren Agar, Marina McLaughlin, Barry Kingsley (senior management)

- Playground Equipment:
    - Funded only through fundraising
    - playground inspected annually
- Expenses covered by facilities:
    - Facility services pays for base prep where playground equipment sits
    - excavating to create a functional drainage layer
    - facilities covers the cost below ground; school councils have to fundraise for what is above ground (the playground structure)
- Accessibility:
    - law to make outdoor play spaces accessible
- Procurement:
    - make sure playground supplier is giving the best competitive proposal not necessarily the best price (ie. more bang for your buck)
    - procurement developed a process to speed up approval process
    - Ministry of Education sets restrictions on what fundraising can be used for
- Selection of a Playground Design:
    - Once a school council has enough money, then facilities reviews and approves of the playground based on the location
    - submitted proposals provided to each member of the evaluation committee (principal/VP, parent council member, teacher)
- Proposal Review:
    - Proposals for playground:
        - sometimes get best design with a little more money because the businesses are motivated to give the board the best package to win the deal
        - Example costs: Crestview School cost facilities and the school council a total of $120,000 (playground and the grounds); $15,000-$20,000 for grounds; $100,000 for playground

- before starting fundraising: talk to facilities; plan 5-7 years ahead of playground replacement
- playground cost is not covered; school council needs to raise funds for it
- one slide costs: $30,000
- member suggestion: Love My Hood: suggestion to send this grant info to principals and school councils
    - Michelle Newlands' idea: the principals meet monthly so she can see the option of best practices told to them as well.
- facilities: natural playgrounds (ie. wood structures) are much more expensive and don't last as long as regular playgrounds
- facilities wants to create more places where people can talk and read and not just have playgrounds
- member question: How do we find out if our playground will be deemed unusable 3 years out? Facilities response: The principal will have a plan; assessment committee

Parent Engagement Fund:

- $500 every Sept.
- schedule a GL account
- secretaries and admins know where it goes
- ideas for PRO grant: volunteer tea; cover cost of paper photocopying
- school councils can ask where the Ministry Grant money is going to; school councils may be allowed to use it, but it is at the principal's discretion

Month by Month suggestions for School Councils & Chairs of what to cover: Chair Sara

- September:
    - Chair should sit with the principal before the first school council meeting; discuss the agenda
    - council rep should be at the open house
    - at the first school council meeting: council's goals for the year should be discussed. 2 goals/ year can bring a focus to the work the group does
    - recap what was successful the year before
    - give council members homework for the next meeting
    - member question surrounding the PRO grant: Michelle Newlands: amount awarded to a school is not a set amount anymore; decide what you would like to do (reach for the stars) and request if you can do it; be ambitious
    - have a plan at your first council meeting, nail down dates of your meetings for the year
    - create consistency through school council
    - vote by school council to decide some things like virtual or in person
    - principals can stop a proposal
    - have a Gmail account for council and organize it for future councils.
- November:
    - does our school have a math action team?
    - add to school council agenda: mental health info, add cyber safety, legality of cell phone use, how to pick the best high school magnet programs as topics, and how new language program is taught; can invite a teacher/rep from the school to speak on this
- January-April:
    - how council is progressing
    - what needs to be accomplished

    - event planning
- May:
    - PRO grant final report
    - School Council report
    - Principal's Report: purpose is to help the board decide on new principal when a principal is leaving; the purpose isn't to evaluate a current principal
    - deadlines for all reports
- June:
    - How did the year go?
    - Did the group accomplish what was set out?
    - Plan for next year: next year's meeting dates because sometimes a principal may leave at an odd time and you have no mechanism to have the next meeting. (ie. some schools have had 12 different principals in 8 years)

What is PIC?

- An important board-level advisory body that operates as a direct link between parents and the board's director of education and trustees.
- provides advice to their school board on parent engagement and ways to communicate with parents
- developing strategies to improve student achievement and well-being
- Notes from PIC:
    - Always looking for new members

Letter to be sent to the Trustees

- letter to advocate for more communication with parents
- wanting a letter sent to parents when their child witnessed (not necessarily engaged in) an incident
- wanting others to help develop an action plan for coping with these situation in the future; want tools to guide conversations
- concerns by members: frequency of letters going out; stigmatization of students with behavioural issues
- actions going forward: lock down exact wording of letter; no vague responses. Our school council needs to pick a very specific wording, agree with this specific wording, or vote against this letter.

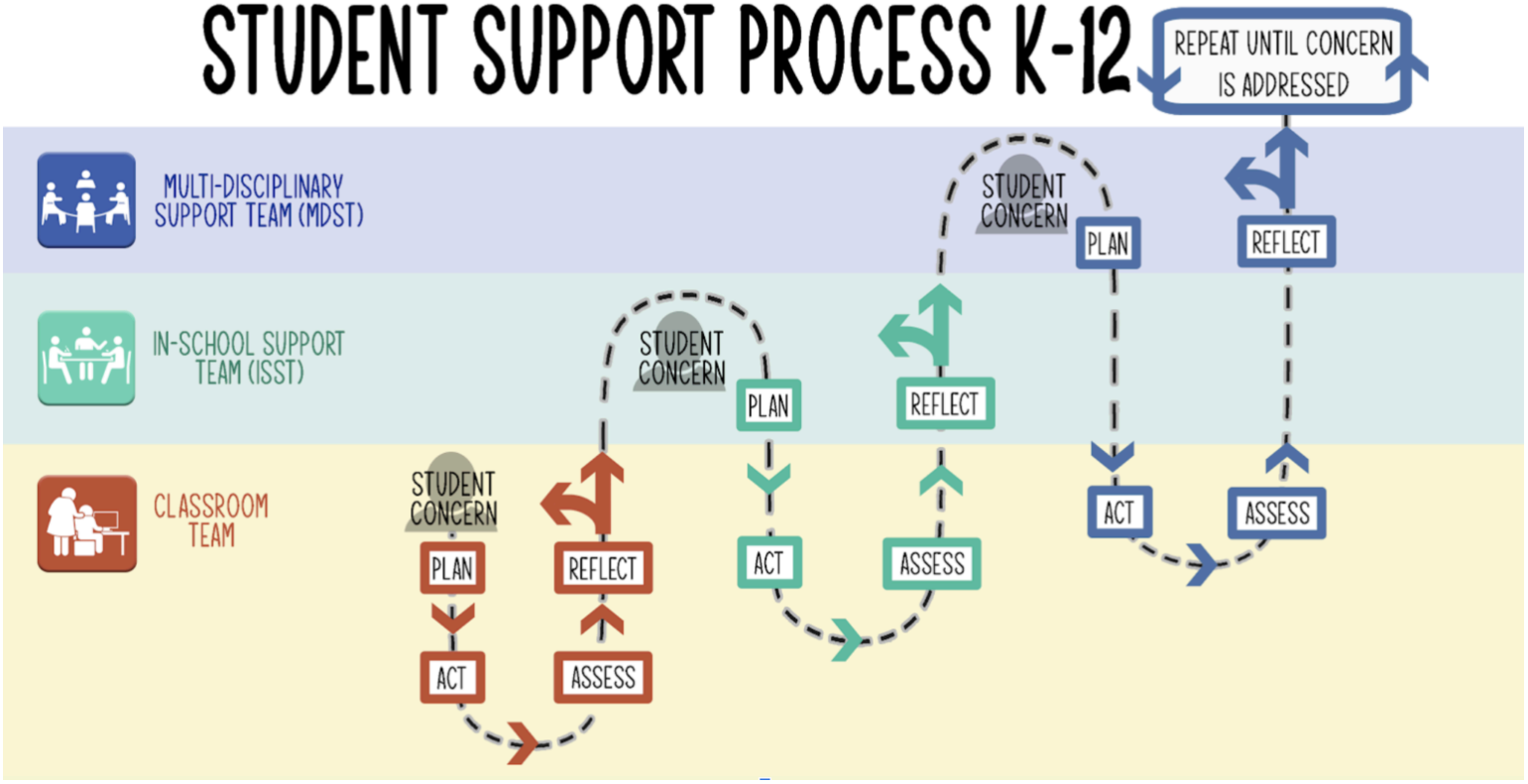
Letter to be sent to Trustees. Advocating communication from schools

Dear WRDSB Trustees,

I am writing on behalf of WRAPSC to advocate for the well-being of our students. We believe it is crucial for caregivers to receive communication from principals and teachers when an incident occurs in front of their child, whether it happens in the classroom or elsewhere on school property. While we understand and respect the need for privacy for those directly involved in these incidents, it is important to recognize that the students who witness these events are also impacted. Many of these students are witnessing moments of violence or emotional instability, which can lead to a normalization of such behavior. As a result, some students are becoming afraid to attend school and are reluctant to speak

about what they have seen. If caregivers were informed about what their child has witnessed, they would be more likely to engage in conversations with their child and provide the necessary support. This could include helping their child develop an action plan for coping with such situations in the future, thereby reducing fear and anxiety. The communication sent home does not need to go into detail about the incident itself but could instead provide tips on how to talk to children about what they've experienced and how to support both students and staff in these situations. Effective communication can only contribute positively to the well-being of our students. We urge you not to use privacy as an excuse to withhold such important communication. After all, caregivers regularly receive notifications about public health issues like lice without privacy concerns being cited and these situations affect student well-being as well. We ask that the WRDSB develop a letter, much like the one used for lice, to inform caregivers any time their child has witnessed an incident. Thank you for considering this important matter. We believe that by working together, we can create a safer and more supportive environment for our students.

STUDENT SUPPORT PROCESS K-12



nutrition for learning

THE PARENT COUNCIL INFO PACK

TOGETHER LET'S FUEL BRIGHT FUTURES



THANK YOU FOR YOUR LEADERSHIP.

Dear Parent Council,

We are SO grateful you're here!

What our communities need more of right now is people like YOU, volunteering to help magnify opportunities for every school day to be as nourishing, equitable, and full of opportunity as it can be.

Did you know that Nutrition for Learning has been providing funding, food delivery, and food program support to schools in Waterloo Region for 27 years? Yes! Since 1997, we're linked arms with the school boards to help ensure no student is ever too hungry to learn.

We know that as Parent Council, you believe in supporting non-stigmatizing, nourishing ways for students to thrive. You'll love knowing that Nutrition for Learning school food programs are universally accessible, so that no student ever feels singled out for needing some support. Our fresh produce, proteins, and whole grains are there for any student who's hungry, no questions asked.

It's no secret that food insecurity is rising at record-breaking rates in our communities:

- 1 in 3 children do not regularly eat breakfast.
- 33% of food bank users are children.
- Our food costs were over $1.7M last school year, a 142% increase in just 2 fiscal years.

We need your help. Nutrition for Learning works hard to cover the majority of your school's nutrition program costs, but - put frankly - we've never seen a rate of usage like this. This package features some ideas to get involved, fundraise for your program, and be a student nutrition champion. I would also love to connect with you any time, please reach out and say hello!



Kerry Moco
School Engagement & Youth Wellbeing
kmoco@nutritionforlearning.ca

THE MISSION.

In partnership with youth and educators, we continually strive to elevate the experience of universal food access at schools in ways that promote optimal wellbeing, healthy relationships, and food literacy.

THE VISION.

A Waterloo Region where all students are nourished at school so they can learn, connect, participate, and thrive.

WE BELIEVE:

- When students are nourished, their capacity to imagine, explore, and connect elevates. Every student deserves a fair shot by being well nourished during their school day.
- No young person should feel stigmatized for accessing food at school.
- Food is community. We nurture the idea that food can connect people and places. When students eat nutritious food together, mental, physical, and community health improves.
- The unique perspectives of students are needed on our mission to improve universal access to food at schools.



NUTRITION FOR LEARNING CORE VALUES

STUDENT-CENTRED.

We create opportunities to prioritize the voices and best interests of those we serve. We ensure that students have a "seat at the table" in creating a healthier future for young people in Waterloo Region.

UNIVERSAL & INCLUSIVE.

As a youth-serving organization committed to universally accessible programs, we ensure that diverse voices and views help shape our work.

LEARNING IS THRIVING.

We co-create environments that nurture personal and professional expansion. We celebrate wins and challenges together, and strive to better ourselves through both.

TRUST LEADS TO GROWTH.

We foster trust by believing the best in others.
We strive to be the kinds of people that others have faith in by leading with kindness and authenticity in all interactions.

STEWARDING THE FUTURE.

With long-term impact as our goal, we honour our donors, partners, and stakeholders by being socially, financially, and environmentally responsible and accountable.

HOW PARENT COUNCIL CAN HELP.

THE CRITICAL NEED

Did you know, an average school program costs $15,000, with some costing as high as $70,000!? And that funding from the Ministry of Children, Community, and Social Services covers less than 30% of our region's program funding?

With over 180 programs in schools across Waterloo region and the highest rates of food insecurity in our community's history, we need our community's support more than ever. Here are some ways your parent council can help.

LET'S FUNDRAISE!

Currently, school fundraising accounts for ~7% of our total revenue, but it's growing every year! And every dollar counts. A simple $200 fundraiser can help provide as many as 180 meals delivered right to your school.

Get your school involved and host your own school fundraiser like a 'read-a-thon', bake sale, talent show or car wash. No matter the fundraiser, you can contact our team to set up a fundraising page to help you raise funds for your program.

GET INVOLVED.

Participate in our upcoming fundraising events, outlined on Pages 6 & 7! Or create one that suits your school's needs. Whether it is a bake sale, charity run, or auction, your involvement helps raise vital funds and fosters a strong community spirit.

SPREAD THE WORD.

If you're not in a position to donate, we challenge you to find a monthly donor! Just $20 a month (2 lattes and muffins!) provides over 200 meals a YEAR!

You can also share our fundraising campaigns with friends, family, and colleagues. The more people know, the more support we can gather to sustain these essential programs. Follow us on Instagram (@nutritionforlearning) and tag us in your school's program and initiatives.

FUNDRAISING IDEAS TO HELP FUND YOUR SCHOOL'S NUTRITION PROGRAM

COOL TO BE KIND BRACELET FUNDRAISER

Campaign Dates: November 4-29, 2024

In celebration of World Kindness Day on November 13th, throughout the month of November, students across Waterloo Region can show kindness to themselves and their peers by purchasing friendship-style bracelets for $2 each, or 3 for $5, with all proceeds going to your school's Nutrition for Learning program.

Nutrition for Learning will provide the following materials to make your school's Cool to Be Kind Bracelet Fundraiser a success:

- Friendship bracelets
- Posters
- Social media assets to share with your community!
- Email copy to be sent through School Day notifying your community about the fundraiser!



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TOONIE DRIVE

Campaign Dates: Anytime during the 2024-2025 school year!

One of the simplest and most accessible ways to fundraise is by hosting a change drive!

During your chosen campaign window, print Nutrition for Learning's Toonie Drive flyers and send them home with your students. Families, neighbours, and/or friends can then tape a toonie, or any extra change, to the flyer. Send a message to parents through your virtual platform to boost your fundraising results!

Nutrition for Learning will provide the following materials to make your school's Toonie Drive a success!

- Toonie Drive Flyers - colouring pages for your students to customize before taking home! *(best printed on heavier weight paper)*
- Fundraising page where donations can be made directly online.
- Social media assets to share with your community!
- Email copy to be sent through School Day notifying your community about the fundraiser!

OTHER FUNDRAISING IDEAS

- Bake sales
- Walk-a-thon & dance-a-thons
- Staff fundraisers *ie: Loaded potato lunch $5*
- Raffles
- Be creative! What fits with your school community to raise funds for N4L?



RESOURCES AVAILABLE TO PARENT COUNCIL & SCHOOL STAFF

WEBINARS.

Attend our LIVE WEBINAR on how N4L works and ways parent council can make an impact! This session will also be recorded.

Monday, September 23rd at 6:00-6:30 PM

Email kmoco@nutritionforlearning.ca to register or request the recording.

Zoom meeting link will be sent upon registration.

LET'S CONNECT.

When available, our team is pleased to speak at school assemblies about Nutrition for Learning programs or connect with parent council to help brainstorm ideas and strategies that work for your unique school community and group of parent/community volunteers.

Be in touch any time!

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Together, we can ensure every student has the energy and focus they need to reach their full potential.

Let's make 2024-2025 the best school year yet!



nutrition for learning